

AI Travel Planner

From saved inspiration to a practical travel magazine

An AI-assisted web application that turns scattered travel inspiration into verified place suggestions, a personal map, and an editable daily itinerary.

What is the proposed product?

The proposed application helps travelers transform TikTok and Instagram links, screenshots, written recommendations, and voice notes into an organized trip. Users can also discover videos from participating creators or licensed travel-content providers. The final output is an interactive digital travel magazine: a visual guide combining daily plans, maps, source content, practical details, and editing controls.

Problem and opportunity

The problem hypothesis is that travelers can collect inspiration easily but still spend substantial time identifying venues, checking locations, comparing travel times, and arranging realistic days. Saves may be scattered across applications, contain several places, or omit important details. Interviews and a pilot would test how often this problem occurs and whether travelers would pay to solve it.

Target users and objectives

- **Primary users:** independent travelers planning a three-to-seven-day city trip from approximately 10–50 saved ideas.
- **Secondary users:** friends planning together and travel creators who want audiences to use their recommendations.
- **Objectives:** reduce manual research, improve place identification, reduce unnecessary travel, and make the resulting plan easy to understand and change.

Why this approach?

The proposed value is the connection between personal inspiration and a practical schedule. Existing products such as Mindtrip and Wanderlog already provide related planning features, so differentiation must be demonstrated through import reliability, evidence for place matches, and ease of editing. The proposal does not claim to introduce an entirely new product category. [6] [7]

Project status: concept proposal, not an implemented application. Proposed prices, targets, and outcomes require validation. Prepared 11 September 2026.

From inspiration to itinerary

The user remains in control while the application coordinates content interpretation, place lookup, and scheduling. Only accessible content with an appropriate permission basis is processed. An unavailable or unclear save remains in the inbox until the user adds information or chooses to skip it.

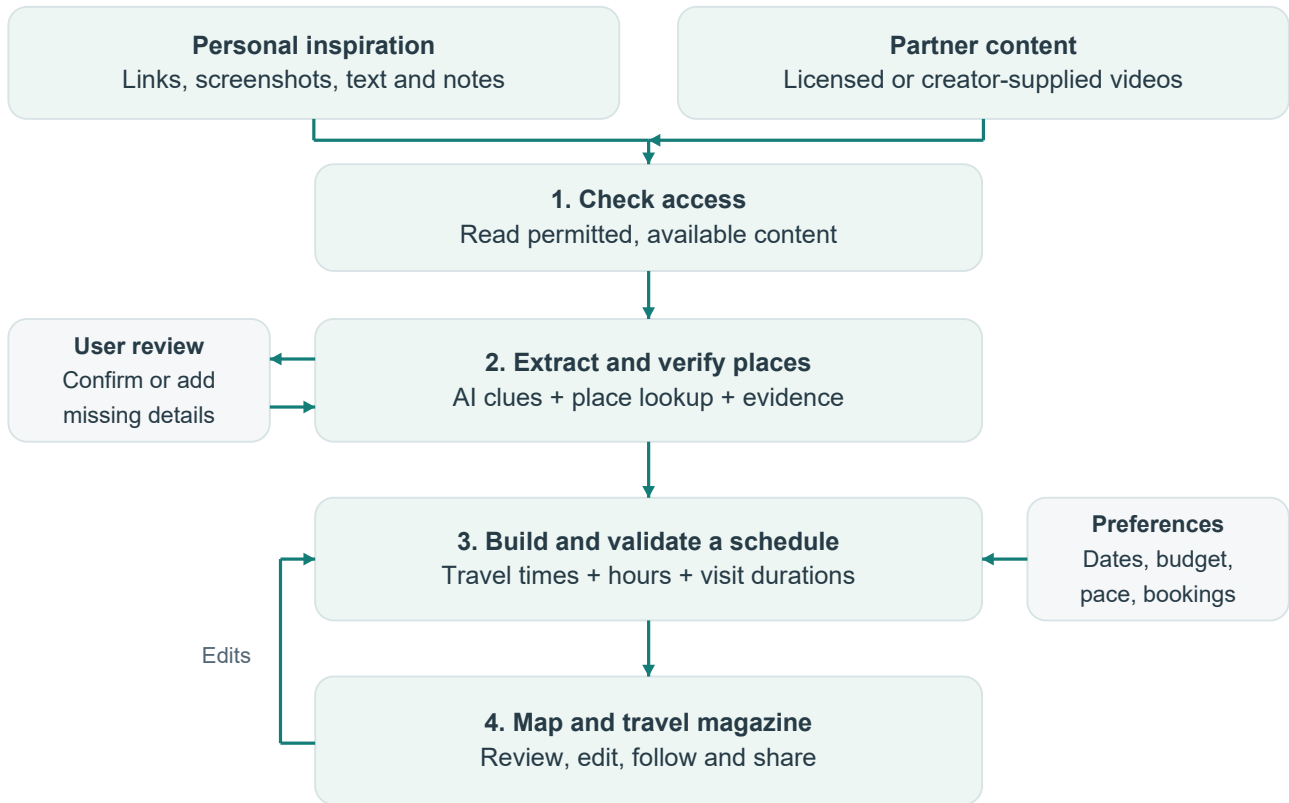


Figure 1. High-level product flow. Side inputs show user clarification and trip constraints; the return arrow represents itinerary edits.

What happens behind the flow?

- **Understand:** read text, transcribe permitted audio, and inspect relevant image or video frames to identify venue clues.
- **Verify:** match those clues to real places, remove duplicates, and ask the user to confirm uncertain branches or locations.
- **Plan:** use dates, visit durations, reservations, opening windows, and travel estimates to create and validate a feasible schedule.
- **Present:** render the approved schedule as a map, timeline, and magazine. Revalidate affected sections when the user edits the plan.

AI interprets content and preferences; a scheduling engine checks timing and constraints. OR-Tools provides a documented foundation for routing with time windows. This supports practical scheduling, not a guarantee of the globally optimal trip. [4]

A focused first release

The minimum viable product (MVP) should support one destination and complete the full journey from a saved idea to an editable trip. Broader discovery and advanced collaboration can follow after the core workflow is reliable.

Feature	What the user can do	Release
Inspiration inbox	Paste supported links, upload screenshots, or add text. See import progress and recover incomplete saves.	MVP
Place extraction and confirmation	Review identified venues with their original sources; confirm uncertain matches and the correct branch.	MVP
Personal map	View saved places, inspect details, remove duplicates, and mark priorities.	MVP
Preference-based itinerary	Set dates, accommodation, budget, transport, daily pace, must-visit stops, and reservations.	MVP
Schedule checks	Arrange visits using available opening windows, travel estimates, visit durations, and breaks; explain conflicts.	MVP
Interactive travel magazine	Explore visual daily pages with a timeline, map, practical notes, and original inspiration.	MVP
Editing and private sharing	Move or replace stops, preserve fixed bookings, and share a revocable viewing link.	MVP
Voice-note intake	Transcribe spoken recommendations and turn them into candidate places.	Extension
Licensed video discovery	Browse destination-specific videos from licensed providers or participating creators.	Extension; access-dependent
Group planning	Invite editors, collect preferences, and coordinate changes without overwriting others.	Extension

What makes the magazine interactive?

A stop is more than a picture: it has a scheduled time, source, place reference, and actions such as Move, Replace, View source, and Open directions. Layouts use designed templates so that the AI does not invent page structures or factual details.

Example scenario

A traveler provides 15 saved ideas for a four-day trip. The app identifies the usable places, asks about an ambiguous café branch, and proposes daily groups of stops. A fixed dinner reservation stays locked while the traveler makes an afternoon less busy. This is an illustrative workflow, not a measured performance result.

Needs and acceptance criteria

Each story connects a user need to an observable result. These criteria would guide implementation and evaluation of the proposed prototype.

ID	User story	Acceptance criterion
US-01	As a traveler, I want to add social links and screenshots so that my inspiration is collected in one place.	Each input is saved with a source and status. Failed extraction preserves the save and offers a recovery action.
US-02	As a traveler, I want venue details and map pins extracted so that I can avoid repeating manual research.	A successful match shows its source and place location. Ambiguous branches require confirmation.
US-03	As a traveler, I want to set my dates, budget, transport, and pace so that the itinerary fits my needs.	The planner uses the saved preferences, distinguishes estimates from confirmed facts, and identifies conflicts.
US-04	As a traveler, I want my places organized into daily routes so that I can reduce unnecessary travel and avoid known closure times.	The schedule includes travel and visit time and passes checks against the available opening windows.
US-05	As a traveler, I want to change a stop while keeping a reservation so that I can adapt the day without losing commitments.	The reservation stays fixed; affected stops are revalidated, and incompatible changes are explained.
US-06	As a traveler, I want a visual travel magazine so that I can understand and follow my trip easily.	The same saved itinerary appears consistently in the magazine, timeline, and map.
US-07	As a trip organizer, I want to share my itinerary privately so that my companions can review it.	The sharing link grants only its intended access, can be revoked, and does not expose private uploads.
US-08	As a traveler, I want to browse relevant licensed videos so that I can discover places when my own saves are insufficient.	Discovery results can be filtered by destination and linked to places; rights and attribution are recorded. Extension.

Unknown information must stay visible as unknown. The app should not invent a venue, opening hour, price, or confirmed booking to make a story appear complete.

How the startup could earn money

A paid trip is the proposed starting model because planning is often tied to a particular holiday. A free allowance lets users experience successful imports before purchasing a complete plan. All figures below are illustrative USD assumptions, not supplier quotations or revenue forecasts.

Revenue stream	Proposed offer	Reason to test
Freemium → Trip Pass	Free: a small import allowance, personal map, and itinerary preview. Paid: about \$15 per trip for the full plan, magazine, sharing, and defined processing limits.	A clear purchase attached to a finished planning outcome.
Annual plan (later)	Test approximately \$59 per year for a specified number of trips and a processing allowance.	May suit frequent travelers after repeat usage is demonstrated.
Affiliate referrals	Earn an agreed commission when a traveler completes a qualifying booking through a partner link.	Adds revenue from relevant experiences; eligibility and terms depend on the partner.
Creator or business plan (later)	Charge for reusable branded guides and collaboration tools; test pricing with creators and small travel businesses.	Potential recurring revenue from customers who prepare guides frequently.

Illustrative economics for one paid trip

Item	Assumption
Trip Pass revenue	\$15.00
AI, maps, processing, and allocated content/delivery costs	\$5.00
Payment-processing allowance	\$0.75
Contribution before other business costs	\$9.25

Contribution is not profit. Free-user usage, fixed licenses, hosting, marketing, support, refunds, taxes, and staff costs must also be covered. The \$5 processing/content assumption requires measurement and commercial quotes; expensive licensing or frequent video processing may make a \$15 price unsuitable.

Customer acquisition and pricing validation

Recruit travelers with upcoming trips through destination communities and creator partnerships. Demonstrate how real saves become an editable itinerary, with permission to use the examples. Measure paid conversion, cost per completed trip, and acquisition cost. Keep sponsored content labeled and preserve itinerary quality when commission rates differ.

A realistic proposal to evaluate

The project is technically plausible as a constrained prototype. Its principal uncertainty is dependable access to useful content, followed by correct place matching and willingness to pay. The first evaluation should test the full workflow rather than promise universal social-video downloading.

Challenge	Proposed response
Social-video access	Use supported access routes, user-provided content, and creator permissions. TikTok's Display API focuses on creator metadata and display; Meta's professional-account APIs also have defined access scopes. Keep screenshot/text fallbacks. [1] [2]
Content licensing	Evaluate a provider such as NaviSavi, which advertises licensed videos and app API access. No partnership is secured. Confirm commercial display, AI processing, retention, and pricing in writing. [3]
Accuracy and freshness	Show evidence for venue matches; ask about ambiguity. Recheck time-sensitive details and mark missing hours or prices as uncertain.
Cost and privacy	Process slow work in background jobs; limit retries and usage. Keep trips and uploads private by default, with deletion and controlled sharing.
Map-provider conditions	Use permitted storage, refresh, and attribution practices. Google Places places restrictions on content reuse and distinguishes place IDs from other data. [5]

Proposed pilot and success measures

Test one destination with about 20 target users and 200 representative saves. Proposed targets are at least 95% correct venue-and-branch matches among automatically pinned results, useful recovery for failed imports, and no known hard-constraint violations in accepted test schedules. Measure coverage separately, including access failures. Compare planning time with the user's existing method and test real willingness to pay. These are evaluation targets, not achieved results.

References

[1] TikTok for Developers — Display API overview
[2] Meta — Official Instagram API collection
[3] NaviSavi — Licensed travel-video API
[4] Google OR-Tools — Routing with time windows
[5] Google — Places API policies and attribution
[6] Mindtrip — Product overview
[7] Wanderlog — Product overview

Sources checked 11 September 2026. Provider capabilities, permissions, prices, and availability may change. The proposal recommends a scoped prototype and validation; it reports no completed implementation or confirmed commercial partnership.